

Marcela Espinosa

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior Product Designer with a focus on AI-native UX for enterprise SaaS and consumer platforms. Experience spans establishing org-wide AI UX standards, shaping AI product vision, and leading design systems overhauls. Track record of reducing multi-week manual workflows to hours through research-driven, AI-assisted product design.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Systems Thinking at Scale, Ambiguity to Clarity, End-to-End Product Design, Cross-Functional Influence, AI Tools & Workflow Fluency, Trust & High-Stakes UX, Platform & Design Systems, 0-to-1 Product Design

WORK EXPERIENCE

Drata

Aug 2022 - May 2026

Senior Product Designer

- Designed TPRM Agent, Drata's first AI-assisted vendor risk assessment, creating guided workflows for analyzing vendor documentation against security criteria and reducing reviews from weeks to hours. Partnered with 6 enterprise customers to validate workflows before release.
- Pioneered Mapping Agent, Drata's AI-first framework mapping experience, a self-serve workflow surfacing AI-generated recommendations for custom compliance frameworks, reducing a 6-week Drata-assisted process to hours. Drove a full architecture pivot that required buy-in across multiple internal departments.
- Established an AI UX Framework defining human-AI interaction patterns, explainable AI standards, AI-native design workflows, and baseline tone-of-voice guidelines for conversational AI experiences, adopted across the design org. Packaged the framework into playbooks and a Claude-powered tool to guide pattern selection and prototyping prompts.
- Built Drata's AI design foundation: 4 AI design playbooks, 6 AI UX design principles, and 9 AI Trust Patterns for agentic transparency and user control.
- Developed a four-stage AI autonomy model, a slider running from least to most AI control depending on what the user has granted, with each stage defining its own parameters for trust, transparency, and auditability; adopted as Drata's product vision for progressive AI autonomy.
- Drove design systems evolution through Constellation, a platform-wide information architecture and design systems overhaul that established scalable, consistent patterns, resolved design debt, validated patterns against real workflows, and rolled out to **8,000+ customers**. Designed with responsiveness in mind throughout, desktop as the primary viewport with layouts and components built to adapt cleanly to smaller screens.
- Led research and product design for Evidence Library, an evidence-centric system enabling reuse across multiple controls and syncing with Jira, ServiceNow, and Asana; reached **72% customer activation** and **41% integration** into ongoing compliance workflows.
- Led research, validation, and the first release of Drata's access review workflow, a 0-to-1 feature customers had been asking for. Reviewers could complete access reviews for every connected app in one place, with flagged access changes surfacing what needed attention first.
- Delivered Trust Center features, including an analytics dashboard and a Salesforce integration that automated document access approvals using CRM data.
- Co-planned and participated in a week-long AI strategy design sprint to define the future of the product around AI; vibe-coded a future-state version of the app with new AI-driven interactions using v0 and Claude Code, surfacing areas to enhance and automate with AI and informing Drata's AI UX Framework.

HealthCare.com

Sep 2021 - Jul 2022

Product Designer

- Led design for an insurance marketplace, conducting moderated user interviews and usability testing across the quoting-to-checkout journey to uncover trust and conversion barriers in a complex, high-stakes purchase flow. Redesigned landing pages, quoting flows, checkout experiences, and comparison features to increase clarity and user confidence in financial decision-making.

UX/UI Designer

- Designed UX and interface components for Emojo, a personalized adaptive learning platform serving teachers and students, collaborating with product and engineering to deliver learning experiences and curriculum features.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

PUBLICATIONS

Designing Support Tools for Young Adults with Autism to Self-Manage Stress and Anxiety [ACM Digital Library](#) 2019-2021

Presented at CLIHC 2021. Published: Nov 2021. Conducted HCI research using user-centered and participatory design methods. Designed and tested low- and high-fidelity prototypes with stakeholder evaluation. Explored interaction design approaches for mental health support tools.

Designing a Stress and Anxiety Support Tool to Help Young Adults with Autism in Daily Living [Interacting with Computers \(Oxford University Press\)](#) 2022

Published: Mar 2023. Extended research developing SATORI, a three-interface anxiety-management support tool grounded in five design principles. Evaluated with 8 autistic young adults, co-authored with Lizbeth Escobedo (Dalhousie University).

EDUCATION

Master's degree, Engineering and Innovation [Cetys Universidad](#) 2018 - 2020

Bachelor's degree, Mechatronics [Cetys Universidad](#) 2010 - 2014

International Exchange: Università degli Studi di Bergamo, Italia

SKILLS

Design Strategy: Product Design, UX Strategy, Enterprise SaaS, Workflow Automation, Stakeholder Management, OKR-Driven Goal Setting

AI & XAI: AI UX, AI Product Design, Explainable AI, AI-Native UX, Generative AI, AI Prototyping, Human-in-the-Loop Design, AI Evaluation Framework, Progressive Autonomy

Research & Architecture: User Research, Usability Testing, Information Architecture, Interaction Design, Design Systems, Prototyping, Journey Mapping, WCAG Accessibility Compliance

Tools: Figma, Dovetail, Storybook, Figma Make, Claude Code, v0, ChatGPT, Gemini, Glean, HTML/CSS (reading only, not production code), Amplitude

Languages: Spanish (Native), English (Native proficiency)